Summary

During this chapter, you made some great strides in the data layer of your app. You established solid database models and mechanisms to efficiently handle schema changes and optimize queries. You started out by creating Eloquent models that defined one-to-many relationships (like users having multiple posts) and many-to-many relationships (such as posts tagged with multiple tags). You used Artisan to generate migration files, added the necessary fields and relationships, and then executed the migrations on your Linux system. Then, you enhanced the development and testing environment by writing and running seed classes to populate your database with realistic test data. You finally took care of those performance issues by tweaking those tricky database queries with eager loading. That really cut down on the number of queries and sped things up. All the steps were built on solid principles, so you could be sure that your database interactions were both scalable and maintainable.